

MRI Foreground/Background Detection

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Abstract

This note outlines how we derive foreground and background masks for MRI volumes in RadQy. Each section documents one detection method, its assumptions, and the clean-up steps needed so FG/BG pixels are reproducible across datasets.

Contents

1	Introduction	2
2	Image Processing Segmenters	2
2.1	OtsuHull (OtsuHull.py)	2
3	Deep Learning Segmenters	2
3.1	U-Net (placeholder)	2
4	Notes for Integration	2
	References	2

1 Introduction

This document lists the foreground/background (FG/BG) segmentation methods in `backend/seg/mri`. Each section mirrors a Python module and notes its inputs, thresholds, morphology, and fallbacks so downstream IQMs get consistent masks.

2 Image Processing Segmenters

Classical pipelines based on intensity statistics and morphology.

2.1 OtsuHull (`OtsuHull.py`)

Legacy variant mirroring the original hybrid Otsu pipeline with more defensive fallbacks [1]. This subsection is listed first because it matches the earliest implementation shipped with RadQy.

3 Deep Learning Segmenters

Learned models for FG/BG inference.

3.1 U-Net (placeholder)

Planned slot for the learned U-Net FG/BG mask generator. Add architecture details (depth, channels, skips), preprocessing steps, and post-processing (e.g., thresholding, hole filling) when the model is integrated.

4 Notes for Integration

All segmenters operate per 2D slice and return uint8 masks in $\{0,1\}$. Background is always defined as the complement of foreground to ensure downstream IQMs receive matching shapes and disjoint FG/BG sets.

References

- [1] Amir Reza Sadri et al. “MRQy: An open-source tool for the quality control of structural MRI images”. In: *Journal of Imaging* 6.1 (2020). Placeholder entry; replace with canonical citation if available, pp. 1–15.